

Praveen V - Amazon Interview Experience

About the company

Amazon

Amazon.com, Inc., doing business as Amazon, is an American multinational technology company, engaged in e-commerce, cloud computing, online advertising, digital streaming, and artificial intelligence

As of 2024, it is the world's largest online retailer and marketplace, smart speaker provider, cloud computing service through AWS, live-streaming service through Twitch, and internet company as measured by revenue and market share

About the Role:

The Software Development Engineer (SDE) Intern role at Amazon offers students a unique opportunity to gain hands-on experience in software development within one of the world's leading technology companies. As an SDE intern, you will work on real projects that directly impact Amazon's customers, involving tasks such as designing, coding, testing, and deploying software solutions. You'll collaborate with experienced engineers, participate in code reviews, and engage in design discussions, all while solving complex technical problems that require innovative approaches. Amazon provides a supportive environment with mentorship and access to internal resources to help you grow professionally. This internship not only allows you to apply your programming skills and problem-solving abilities but also gives you a chance to contribute to meaningful projects that can shape the future of Amazon's services. For those who excel, the internship often serves as a pathway to a full-time SDE position at Amazon, making it a valuable stepping stone in your technology career.

Overview of the Process:

The overall process consisted of

- An Online coding contest in HackerRank platform
- Interview Round 1 (Only DSA & Problem Solving) – Online mode

Round-1

- First round was an online test conducted in HackerRank platform. The questions were medium questions. First question was based on DP and other one was based on Binary search
- Next there were some behavioural questions asked. Don't ignore this part as this section also carries some weightage to the selection criteria.

- I solved the first problem fully and was able to pass half the test cases in second one
- Out of more than 400 participants, 85 candidates were shortlisted for the next round.

Round-2

Round 2 was also conducted in online mode on Amazon chime. There were two DSA questions which were of medium and easy difficulty. First question was a modification of Number of Islands problem in leetcode. Second question was finding the pivot index of the array (index where the sum of elements to the right and sum of elements to the left is equal). Both the questions were popular and standard DSA questions.

Number of Islands

<https://leetcode.com/problems/number-of-islands/description/>

Pivot index

<https://leetcode.com/problems/find-pivot-index/description/>

Preparation strategy and Tips

- ◆ Try to learn all the Data structures and the standard question on those data structures
- ◆ Communicate well with the Interviewer and explain the intuition while trying to find the logic of the problem
- ◆ Before diving into the solution always give some brute force approach to the problem and give the optimized solution
- ◆ Learn the time and space complexity of all the data structure operations and algorithms
- ◆ Even if you can't arrive at a solution give your thoughts on approaching the problem
- ◆ Follow the Strivers SDE sheet and try to learn all those topics

<https://takeuforward.org/strivers-a2z-dsa-course/strivers-a2z-dsa-course-sheet-2>

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